

Nicholas J. Ainsworth

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Education

University of California, Irvine

PHD EDUCATION POLICY AND SOCIAL CONTEXT

- Dissertation Co-Chairs: Greg Duncan & Jade Jenkins
- Committee Members: Andrew Penner, Emily Penner, & Nathan Jones

University of California, Irvine

MA EDUCATION

University of Nevada, Las Vegas

MED SPECIAL EDUCATION

Vanderbilt University

BS DISABILITY STUDIES AND POLITICAL SCIENCE

- *Summa cum laude*
- Phi Beta Kappa
- Highest Honors in Political Science

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2026	NAEd/Spencer Dissertation Fellowship , National Academy of Education and Spencer Foundation	\$ 27,500
	AERA-NSF Dissertation Grant , American Educational Research Association and National Science Foundation (Declined for NAEd/Spencer Fellowship)	\$ 27,500
	Roe L. Johns Travel Grant , Association for Education Finance and Policy	\$ 500
2024	Conference Attendance Grant , Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness	\$ 600
	Education Policy Academy Fellow , American Enterprise Institute	\$ 750
2022	UC Irvine Integrated Research Training-Language and Literacy Disabilities Fellowship , Office of Special Education Programs, U.S. Department of Education	\$ 140,223

Publications

† equal authorship

PUBLISHED

Ainsworth, N. J.[†] & Duncan, G. J.[†] (2026). Reducing Intergenerational Poverty. *Academic Pediatrics*, 103423. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.acap.2026.103423>

Ainsworth, A. J.[†], **Ainsworth, N. J.**[†], Liu, Y., & Penner, E. K. (2026). The Early Intervention and Early Childhood Special Education Workforce: Descriptive Evidence on Demographics and Turnover from Oregon. *Journal of Research on Educational Effectiveness*, 0(0), 1–32. <https://doi.org/10.1080/19345747.2025.2611909>

Duncan, G. J., Magnuson, K., Kunin-Batson, A. S., Yoshikawa, H., Fox, N. A., Halpern-Meekin, S., **Ainsworth, N. J.**, Black, S. R., Nelson, J. M., Nelson, T. D., Georgieff, M. K., Karhson, D., Gennetian, L. A., & Noble, K. G. (2025). Cash Transfers and Their Effect on Maternal and Young Children's Health: A Randomized Clinical Trial. *JAMA Pediatrics*, 179(8):867–875. <https://doi.org/10.1001/jamapediatrics.2025.1612>

Media coverage: *The Atlantic*, *The Oregonian*

REVISE & RESUBMIT

Ainsworth, N. J., Cleveland, C., & Penner, A. The Effects of Response to Intervention on Disability Identification and Achievement. (Second Revise & Resubmit, *Journal of Human Resources*). EdWorkingPaper: 24-1010. <https://doi.org/10.26300/72jm-2m09>

Ainsworth, N. J., Ainsworth, A. J., Cleveland, C., Clark, L. R., Brummet, Q., Penner, E. K., Hibel, J., Saultz, A., Spiegel, M., & Penner, A. Gifted Identification Across the Distribution of Family Income. (Revise & Resubmit, *Educational Researcher*). EdWorkingPaper: 26-1375. <https://doi.org/10.26300/f3f6-vf51>

Media coverage: *Chalkbeat*

Ainsworth, N. J., Cleveland, C., Hibel, J., Clark, L. R., Brummet, Q., Saultz, A., Penner, E. K., Spiegel, M., Yoo, P. Y., Cristancho, J. C., Hanselman, P., & Penner, A. School-Based Disability Identification Varies by Student Family Income. (Revise & Resubmit, *American Educational Research Journal*). EdWorkingPaper: 26-1374. <https://doi.org/10.26300/dpwm-2673>

Media coverage: *The 74*, *Chalkbeat*

Ainsworth, N. J. & Hashim, S. M. The Association of Frequent Pediatric Headache with Academic, Cognitive, and Behavioral Outcomes: A Longitudinal Sibling Comparison Study. (Revise & Resubmit, *Headache: The Journal of Head and Face Pain*).

UNDER REVIEW

Ainsworth, A. J. & **Ainsworth, N. J.** Comparing Access to Special Education Staff in Public and Private Schools. (Under Review, *AERA Open*).

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

Ainsworth, N. J., Ainsworth, A. J., Cleveland, C., Hibel, J., Clark, L. R., Saultz, A., Brummet, Q., Penner, E. K., & Penner, A. The Family Resource Dynamics of Special Education Entry and Exit Through the COVID-19 Pandemic

Ainsworth, N. J. & Jenkins, J. M. The Effect of Part C Early Intervention on Elementary School Outcomes: Regression Discontinuity Evidence from North Carolina

Cristancho, J. C., **Ainsworth, N. J.**, & Jenkins, J. M. Public Preschool Expansion and the Childcare Market: Evidence from California

Ainsworth, N. J., Jenkins, J. M., Watts, T. W., & Dodge, K. A. The Impact of State Pre-Kindergarten Funding on the Identification and Achievement of Students with Disabilities

Jenkins, J. M., **Ainsworth, N. J.**, Moran, C., Cha, E., Watts, T. W., & Dodge, K. A. State Preschool Investments and Population Achievement

Ainsworth, A. J., **Ainsworth, N. J.**, Cleveland, C., Hanselman, P., Clark, L. R., Saultz, A., Brummet, Q., Penner, E. K., & Penner, A. The Long-Run Impacts of Elementary School Gifted Identification into Adulthood

REPORTS

Ainsworth, A. J., **Ainsworth, N. J.**, Liu, Y., & Penner, E. K. (2025). *Oregon EI/ECSE Trends in Recruitment and Retention Brief*

Wu, T., **Ainsworth, N. J.**, Yu, A., & Jenkins, J. M. (2025). *Program Evaluation of the Orange County In-Home Licensed Child Care Program*

Ainsworth, N. J., Ainsworth, A. J., Hibel, J., Penner, A. (2023). *Trends in the Identification of Students with Disabilities in Oregon: 2009-2022*

Presentations

* *presenting author*

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Ainsworth, N. J. & Hashim, S.M. (2026). Association of Pediatric Headache with Academic and Behavioral Outcomes in the United States. Poster: 19th Annual International Child Neurology Congress, Taipei, Taiwan.

- Ainsworth, A. J. & **Ainsworth, N. J.** (2026). Comparing Access to Special Education Staffing in Public and Private Schools. Paper: Annual Meeting of the American Educational Research Association, Los Angeles, CA.
- Ainsworth, N. J.***, Cleveland, C., Hibel, J., Clark, L. R., Brummet, Q., Saultz, A., Penner, E. K., Spiegel, M., Yoo, P. Y., Cristancho, J. C., Hanselman, P., & Penner, A. (2026). School-Based Disability Identification Varies by Student Family Income. Poster: Annual Meeting of the American Educational Research Association, Los Angeles, CA.
- Ainsworth, N. J.***, Cleveland, C., Hibel, J., Clark, L. R., Brummet, Q., Saultz, A., Penner, E. K., Spiegel, M., Yoo, P. Y., Cristancho, J. C., Hanselman, P., & Penner, A. (2026). School-Based Disability Identification Varies by Student Family Income. Paper: 51st Annual Association for Education Finance and Policy Conference, Chicago, IL.
- Ainsworth, N. J.***, Cleveland, C., Hibel, J., Clark, L. R., Brummet, Q., Saultz, A., Penner, E. K., Spiegel, M., Yoo, P. Y., Cristancho, J. C., Hanselman, P., & Penner, A. (2026). School-Based Disability Identification Varies by Student Family Income. Poster: 34th Annual Pacific Coast Research Conference, Long Beach, CA.
- Ainsworth, N. J.***, Cleveland, C., & Penner, A. (2025). The Effects of Response to Intervention on Disability Identification and Achievement. Paper: 47th Annual Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Conference, Seattle, WA.
- Ainsworth, N. J.***, Cleveland, C., & Penner, A. (2025). The Effects of Response to Intervention on Disability Identification and Achievement. Paper: 50th Annual Association for Education Finance and Policy Conference, Washington, DC.
- Ainsworth, N. J.***, Cleveland, C., & Penner, A. (2024). The Effects of Response to Intervention on Disability Identification and Achievement. Paper: Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness Annual Conference, Baltimore, MD.
- Ainsworth, N. J.***, Ainsworth, A. J., Cleveland, C., Hibel, J., Clark, L. R., Saultz, A., Brummet, Q., & Penner, A. (2024). Who is Special Education For? Disability Identification Changes in Oregon Through the COVID-19 Pandemic. Paper: 49th Annual Association for Education Finance and Policy Conference, Baltimore, MD.
- Ainsworth, A. J., **Ainsworth, N. J.**, Penner, E. K., & Liu, Y. (2024). The Early Childhood Special Education Workforce: Descriptive Evidence on Demographics and Turnover from Oregon. Paper: 32nd Annual Pacific Coast Research Conference, Coronado Bay, CA.
- Ainsworth, A. J., **Ainsworth, N. J.***, Penner, E. K., & Liu, Y. (2023). The Early Childhood Special Education Workforce: Descriptive Evidence on Demographics and Turnover from Oregon. Paper: 45th Annual Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Conference, Atlanta, GA.

PUBLIC AND PRACTITIONER TALKS

- Saultz, A., Penner, E. K., **Ainsworth, N. J.***, Ainsworth, A. J., Nienstedt, L., Cleveland, C., Hibel, J., Brummet, Q., Hanselman, P., & Penner, A. (2026). *Oregon Education Policy Research Center*. Presentation for the Education Working Group of the Oregon State Legislature
- Ainsworth, N. J.***, Cleveland, C., Penner, A. (2026). *The Effects of Response to Intervention on Disability Identification and Achievement*. Presentation for the Oregon Department of Education's Office of Enhancing Student Opportunities and the Northwest Regional Education Service District
- Ainsworth, N. J.***, Cleveland, C., Saultz, A., Penner, A. (2024). *The Relationship Between Special Education Identification and Family Income in Oregon*. Presentation for the Oregon Department of Education's Special Education District Support Specialists
- Ainsworth, N. J.*** & Ainsworth, A. J. (2023, 2024). *Education Policy in the United States*. Presentation for fellows of the Trenton Arts Program at Princeton University
- Ainsworth, N. J.***, Ainsworth, A. J., Hibel, J., Penner, A. (2023) *Trends in Oregon Special Education*. Presentation for the Oregon Department of Education's Office of Enhancing Student Opportunities

Teaching Experience

HIGHER EDUCATION

University of California, Irvine

- 2026 **EDUC 265: Applied Regression**, Teaching Assistant and Lab Instructor
- 2024-2026 **EDUC 25: Introduction to Education**, Guest Lecturer
- 2024-2026 **EDUC 140: Classrooms, Courts, and Controversies in Education Policy**, Guest Lecturer
- 2024 **EDUC 265: Applied Regression**, Guest Lab Instructor

University of Nevada, Las Vegas

2021 **ESP 737i: The Resource Room**, Instructor of Record

K-12 EDUCATION

Clark County School District

2021-2022 **Lomie G. Heard Elementary STEM Magnet**, K-2 Resource Special Education Teacher

2019-2021 **Clyde C. Cox Elementary School**, K-2 Self-Contained Special Education Teacher

Research Experience

University of California, Irvine School of Education

SUPERVISOR: DR. JADE JENKINS

- Graduate Student Researcher on *Persistence and Fadeout of Early Childhood Interventions* Project

Irvine, CA
2023-Present

University of California, Irvine Department of Sociology

SUPERVISOR: DR. ANDREW PENNER

- Graduate Student Researcher with the Center for Administrative Data Analysis

Irvine, CA
2023-2025

University of California, Irvine School of Education

SUPERVISOR: DR. GREG DUNCAN

- Graduate Student Researcher on *Baby's First Years* Project

Irvine, CA
2023-2024

National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine

SUPERVISOR: DR. GREG DUNCAN

- Research Assistant for Consensus Report on *Reducing Intergenerational Poverty*

Washington, DC
2022-2023

Service & Professional Development

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

2023-Present **Diverse Educational Community and Doctoral Experience (DECADE)**, PhD Student Mentor

UC Irvine

2023-2025 **Career Pathways for Research in Learning and Education, Analytics and Data Science (CP-LEADS)**, Undergraduate Student Research Mentor

UC Irvine

2023-2024 **Early Childhood Policy Research Group Meetings**, Lab Coordinator

UC Irvine

PEER REVIEW

Conferences: Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness

Journals: Journal of Research on Educational Effectiveness

CONFERENCES

Session Chair: Association for Education Finance and Policy; American Educational Research Association

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Educational Research Association (AERA)

Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP)

Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE)

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)

Council for Exceptional Children (CEC)

OTHER

Designations: U.S. Census Bureau Special Sworn Status

Software: Stata (advanced), R (intermediate), Excel, Qualtrics, $\text{\LaTeX}$